



# Grade 4 Social Studies

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 4 · FULL YEAR · THE FLORIDA HISTORIAN-CITIZEN

160 min per week · 2 lessons weekly

**About this overview.** This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More sources, maps, and activities are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in materials and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Grade 4 Social Studies forms the Florida Historian-Citizen. Bridging from the grammar stage toward the dialectic, scholars interpret Florida sources and maps, build timelines, and explain cause and effect across the whole sweep of Florida's story: first peoples, Spanish exploration, territorial days and the Seminole story, statehood and Civil War, modern growth, civil rights, and Florida's government and economy. Recurring routines — Source Study, Timeline Thread, Map Quest, Council Chamber, and the Historian's Notebook — build real historical skills, while the Virtue Lens connects the story to Optima's seven pillars of virtue.

## THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

### 1 Thinking Like a Florida Historian (Weeks 1–3)

Chronology, sources, and the historian's tools, applied to Florida.

### 3 First Floridians; New Spain + Synthesis 1 (Weeks 7–12)

Florida's first peoples and Spanish exploration, closing with the synthesis Land, People, and First Contact.

### 5 Territorial Florida and the Seminole Story (Weeks 17–20)

Territory days, the Seminole Wars, and the people who lived them.

### 7 Modern Florida Takes Shape (Weeks 24–27)

Railroads, tourism, industry, and growth into the twentieth century.

### 9 Government, Economy, Financial Literacy + Exhibition (Weeks 31–33)

Florida's government, economy, and money basics, then the Florida Historian-Citizen Exhibition.

### 2 Florida Geography (Weeks 4–6)

Florida's regions, landforms, and waters through map work.

### 4 Early Florida History (Weeks 13–16)

Colonies, settlements, and daily life in early Florida, with art and sources as evidence.

### 6 Statehood, Civil War, Reconstruction + Synthesis 2 (Weeks 21–23)

Florida becomes a state and endures war and rebuilding; closes with Florida at a Crossroads.

### 8 Civil Rights and Contemporary Florida (Weeks 28–30)

Civil rights, community leaders, and the Florida of today.

## A TYPICAL WEEK

- Two social studies lessons each week.
- Lesson A, Enter the Story: background knowledge through readings, maps, images, sources, vocabulary, and guided observation.
- Lesson B, Work of the Historian-Citizen: source analysis, timeline reasoning, map work, council deliberation, or notebook synthesis.
- The Virtue Lens runs throughout, connecting Florida's story to Optima's seven pillars of virtue.

**On-Demand (asynchronous).** Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

## TIME COMMITMENT

### 160 minutes / week

two lessons a week, about 80 minutes each

- Each week pairs one background lesson with one applied lesson.
- Synthesis weeks ask scholars to gather prior evidence and present a concise claim or exhibit.

## WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A Historian's Notebook (any notebook) for observations, narrations, and evidence.
- Paper and colored pencils for map and timeline work.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.

**Live school.** Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting twice a week on the school's weekly schedule.